EVOFIT MEALS BUSINESS VAULT

Dietary Consultation Scripts

How to Discuss Nutrition Without Crossing Scope — From Allergies to Emotional Eating

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How to Use These Scripts

These are real conversation frameworks for the five nutrition discussions you'll have most often with clients. Each script includes the context (when you'll need it), the conversation itself (what to say), and notes (what to watch for and where the boundaries are).

Don't memorize these word-for-word. Read them, understand the structure, and then practice delivering the key points in your own voice. The goal is to sound like you — not like you're reading from a playbook.

Every script includes scope-of-practice guidance. Personal trainers can provide general nutrition education and customized meal planning. They cannot diagnose medical conditions, prescribe therapeutic diets, or provide clinical nutrition therapy. These scripts are designed to keep you firmly on the right side of that line.

Script 1: Explaining Macros to Beginners

Context

A new client has never heard of macros — or has heard the word but doesn't know what it means. They might be confused by the numbers on their meal plan. They might have seen "IIFYM" on Instagram and want to know what it's about. Or they simply asked, "What are macros and why do they matter?"

This is one of the most common conversations you'll have. Get it right and the client understands their plan at a deeper level, follows it more consistently, and asks smarter questions going forward.

The Conversation

Open with a simple frame:

> **YOU**
> "Great question. Macros is short for macronutrients. There are three of them, and everything you eat is made up of some combination of the three. Think of them like building materials for your body."

Explain each one simply:

> **YOU**
> "The first is protein. Protein builds and repairs your muscles, supports your immune system, and keeps you feeling full. When you're training, protein is the most important macro to get right. Good sources are things like chicken, fish, eggs, Greek yoghurt, and lean beef."

> **YOU**
> "The second is carbohydrates. Carbs are your body's primary energy source — they're what fuels your workouts and your brain. Carbs are in things like rice, potatoes, oats, fruit, bread, and pasta. They're not the enemy — they're your fuel."

> **YOU**
> "The third is fats. Healthy fats support your hormones, your brain function, and your joints. They're in things like nuts, avocados, olive oil, and salmon. You need fats — the key is choosing quality sources and not overdoing the quantity."

Connect it to their plan:

> **YOU**
> "On your meal plan, you'll see each meal has a macro breakdown — grams of protein, carbs, and fats. I've calculated these specifically for your goals. Your protein is set at [X]g per day because [reason — e.g., you're in a muscle-building phase]. Your carbs are at [X]g because [reason — e.g., you're training 4 days a week and need the fuel]. And your fats are at [X]g to keep your hormones and recovery on track."

Make it practical:

> **YOU**
> "You don't need to obsess over hitting exact numbers. Think of it as a target zone — within 10-15 grams either way on each macro is perfectly fine. The goal is consistency over time, not perfection on any

Script 2: Handling "I Hate Meal Prep"

Context

Your client received their meal plan, looked at the recipes, and immediately felt overwhelmed. "I hate cooking." "I don't have time for meal prep." "This looks like a lot of work." This is one of the most common barriers to adherence, and your response determines whether the client follows the plan or abandons it.

The key insight: the client isn't actually saying they hate cooking. They're saying the plan feels like too much work for their current life. Your job is to reduce the perceived effort, not lecture them on the importance of preparation.

The Conversation

Validate first. Don't dismiss.

> **YOU**
> "I hear you, and you're not alone — most of my clients feel that way at first. The good news is you don't need to be a chef or spend your whole Sunday prepping food. Let me show you what this actually looks like in practice."

Reframe meal prep:

> **YOU**
> "When people hear 'meal prep,' they picture spending 4 hours in the kitchen making 21 meals. That's not what I'm asking you to do. Here's what I mean by prep: spend 60-90 minutes once a week — that's it. In that time, you're going to cook two protein sources, make one batch of carbs, and chop your vegetables. That gives you 80% of what you need for the week."

Give them the minimal viable prep:

> **YOU**
> "Here's the simplest version: on Sunday, cook a batch of chicken and a batch of rice. That covers lunches for the week. For dinners, your plan includes 3-4 recipes that take 15-20 minutes to make fresh. Breakfasts are things like overnight oats or eggs — five minutes max. That's it. You're spending about an hour on Sunday and 15-20 minutes on dinner each night."

Offer alternatives if they still resist:

> **YOU**
> "If even that feels like too much right now, let's start smaller. Follow the plan for just 3 days this week. Prep those 3 days only. See how it goes. Once you see how simple the recipes actually are, most people realise it's way less work than they imagined. And if there are specific recipes that feel complicated, tell me and I'll swap them for simpler ones."

Address the time objection directly:

> **YOU**
> "Can I ask — how much time are you currently spending on food each day? Between deciding what to eat, ordering takeout, waiting for delivery, or standing in front of the fridge? Most people spend more time being indecisive about food than they would following a plan. The plan actually saves time

Script 3: Scope Boundaries — What You Can and Can't Advise On

Context

A client asks you something that falls outside your scope as a personal trainer. Maybe they want specific advice about managing their diabetes through diet, or they're asking about an eating disorder, or they want you to interpret blood work results. This happens to every trainer, and how you handle it defines your professionalism.

The goal is to be honest about your boundaries without making the client feel rejected or dismissed. You want them to get the right help while maintaining their trust in you.

The Conversation

When a client asks about managing a medical condition through diet:

YOU

"That's a really important question and I'm glad you brought it up. Here's where I want to be straight with you: as a personal trainer, I can build you meal plans for general health and fitness goals. But when it comes to managing [their condition] through diet, that's something that really needs a registered dietitian or your doctor to weigh in on. They can prescribe a dietary protocol specifically for [condition], and I can build your meal plan around their recommendations."

YOU

"What I'd love to do is this: get a clear directive from your healthcare provider about what your dietary parameters should be — what to include, what to avoid, any specific nutrient targets. Once I have that, I can incorporate those guidelines into your meal plan so everything works together. That way you get the medical expertise where you need it, and the practical meal planning where I can help. Does that work?"

When a client brings up disordered eating patterns:

YOU

"Thank you for trusting me with that. I want to make sure you get the right kind of support here. What you're describing sounds like something that would really benefit from working with a professional who specialises in eating behaviours — a therapist or counselor who focuses on this area. I'm not qualified to guide you through that, and I'd be doing you a disservice if I tried."

YOU

"What I can do is continue to provide you with a balanced, non-restrictive meal plan that supports your overall health. And if you start working with a specialist, I'll happily coordinate your meal plan with whatever approach they recommend. Would you like me to look into some referral options for you?"

When a client asks about interpreting blood work:

YOU

"I can see why you'd want to understand what those numbers mean for your nutrition. The honest answer is that interpreting blood work is outside my lane — that's your doctor's job. What I'd suggest is: take your results to your next appointment and ask your doctor specifically if there are any dietary

Script 4: Handling Supplement Questions

Context

Every client will eventually ask about supplements. "Should I take protein powder?" "What about creatine?" "My friend takes fat burners, should I?" "I saw this supplement on TikTok..."

Supplements are a minefield of misinformation. Your role is to provide honest, evidence-based guidance on common fitness supplements while steering clients away from snake oil and always deferring to their healthcare provider for anything medical.

The Conversation

The universal supplement framework (use this every time):

> **YOU**
> "Supplements are exactly what the name implies — they supplement your diet. They don't replace good nutrition, and no supplement will fix a bad diet. Let's make sure your meal plan and your overall nutrition are solid first, and then we can talk about what might give you an additional edge."

When asked about protein powder:

> **YOU**
> "Protein powder is one of the few supplements I'd call genuinely useful for most people. It's convenient, it's an efficient way to hit your protein target, and it's well-researched. That said, it's just food — it's dried protein in a convenient form. If you can hit your daily protein target from whole foods alone, you don't need it. If you're falling short, a scoop of whey or plant-based protein in a shake is a simple fix."

> **YOU**
> "In your plan, I've included protein powder in [specific meal/snack]. If you'd prefer to get that protein from whole food instead, I can swap it out. Either way works."

When asked about creatine:

> **YOU**
> "Creatine is the most studied supplement in sports nutrition, and the evidence is strong. It supports strength, power output, and recovery. For most people who are strength training, 3-5 grams of creatine monohydrate per day is a reasonable addition. It's affordable and well-tolerated."

> **YOU**
> "That said — if you have any kidney concerns or medical conditions, check with your doctor first. And know that creatine causes a small amount of water retention, which can show up as a 1-2 pound increase on the scale. That's not fat — it's water in your muscles."

When asked about fat burners:

> **YOU**
> "I'm going to be straight with you: most fat burners are overpriced caffeine pills with marketing behind them. The ones that do contain active ingredients often have side effects — elevated heart rate,

Script 5: Nutrition Goal-Setting Conversations

Context

A new client sits down for their nutrition consultation or first check-in. You need to help them set nutrition goals that are specific, realistic, and connected to their deeper motivations. Most clients come in with vague goals: "eat better," "lose weight," "be healthier." Your job is to turn those into concrete targets they can track and achieve.

This conversation also sets the tone for the entire coaching relationship. If you let them keep a vague goal, you'll both be directionless. If you push too hard for specificity, they'll feel interrogated. The sweet spot is curiosity and clarity.

The Conversation

Start with their words, not yours:

> **YOU**
> "Before we build your plan, I want to understand what success looks like for you. If we work together for the next 3 months and everything goes perfectly — what's different about your life? Don't give me the 'right' answer — give me the real one."

Let them talk. Then probe deeper:

If they say "I want to lose weight":

> **YOU**
> "Okay, weight loss is the goal. Let's get specific. How much weight are you thinking? And more importantly — what does that weight loss mean to you? Is it about how you look, how you feel, fitting into certain clothes, having more energy, getting healthier numbers at the doctor? What's the real reason behind the number?"

If they say "I want to eat healthier":

> **YOU**
> "I love that. What does 'healthier' mean to you specifically? Is it more vegetables? Less processed food? Less takeout? Better energy throughout the day? More structured meals? When you picture 'eating healthy,' what does a typical day look like in your mind?"

If they say "I want more energy":

> **YOU**
> "Let's talk about that. When does your energy drop the most? Is it morning, mid-afternoon, after meals? And what does your current eating look like around those energy crashes? Often the energy issue is directly tied to meal timing and what you're eating at specific points in the day."

Turn vague into specific:

Once you have their real motivation, help them set a SMART nutrition goal:

> **YOU**
> "Based on what you've told me, here's what I'd suggest as your primary nutrition goal for the next 90 days:"

Quick Reference: The Scope Cheat Sheet

Keep this somewhere accessible. When in doubt, check it.

TopicIn Scope (You Can Advise)Out of Scope (Refer Out) Macros and caloriesGeneral targets for fitness goalsTherapeutic diets for medical conditions Meal planningCustom plans for health and body compositionDiets prescribed for diabetes, kidney disease, etc. Food choicesRecommending whole foods, recipe suggestionsEliminating foods to treat allergies or medical conditions SupplementsGeneral fitness supplements (protein, creatine)Supplements to treat medical conditions Weight managementCalorie deficit/surplus strategies for body compositionWeight management for eating disorders HydrationGeneral hydration guidelinesFluid management for medical conditions Meal timingPre/post-workout nutrition, general meal spacingTherapeutic fasting for medical purposes Emotional eatingRecognising patterns and suggesting structureDiagnosing or treating eating disorders Food intolerancesAvoiding reported intolerances in meal plansDiagnosing food allergies or intolerances Children's nutritionGeneral healthy eating guidance for parentsPaediatric dietary therapy **The golden rule:** If a client's question starts with "Can this food cure/treat/manage my [medical condition]?" — the answer is always "Let's get your doctor's input on that, and I'll build your plan around their recommendations." *This guide is part of the EvoFit Meals Business Vault. Access your full vault at meals.evofit.io/vault*

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Build Your Nutrition Coaching Business

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